

Meriç Erler

Game Economy Designer - F2P & Idle Systems

Berlin, Germany | mericerler@gmail.com | linkedin.com/in/mericerler | github.com/merogith
EU work-authorized | English (full professional), Turkish (native) | Available immediately

Summary

Game Economy Designer combining three years of business analytics (pharma, edtech, equity research) with hands-on indie game design and development. I balance progression curves, model monetization levers, and diagnose the health of a game economy from an analytical angle, building the spreadsheets and dashboards behind the call. The cover letter, portfolio and an Idle Bank Tycoon case study (linked) hold the proof.

Core Skills

- **Game economy & F2P:** economy modelling and balancing; sources/sinks and inflation control; progression curves; monetization (IAP, rewarded ads, ARPDAU, ARPPU, eCPM); retention (D1/D7/D30); player psychology, motivation and segmentation.
- **Spreadsheet modelling:** advanced Excel and Google Sheets - parameter-driven models, 400+ linked formulas, sensitivity grids, scenario and A/B design.
- **Data analysis & methods:** Python (pandas, scikit-learn, statsmodels); SQL (window functions); A/B testing; regression; z-tests; logistic models; forecasting.
- **BI & reporting:** Tableau, Power BI, Looker Studio, Google Analytics, KPI dashboards.
- **Build / technical:** custom game engines in JavaScript / TypeScript (Canvas, game loop, rules-vs-render separation); concepts that carry over to Unity; Supabase; Git.

Selected Projects

- **Idle Bank Tycoon - Game Economy Design Case Study** (economy design, monetization, A/B). A redesign aimed at exactly what this role owns: I diagnosed a late-game cash glut, then designed two live-ops monetization levers with anti-inflation guardrails, all in a documented, parameter-driven spreadsheet model. Modelled to a blended $\sim +15.5\%$ ARPDAU, but the part I would point to is the call: ship the lower-risk ad lever first and treat the loan as a retention bet to be measured, not assumed. Full math, sensitivity and sources in the linked study.
- **F2P Game Economy & Balance** (Python, scikit-learn, SQL; synthetic data). The closest I have come to live-ops balancing: on synthetic F2P telemetry I built myself, I diagnosed two exploit-grade premium items and a slow currency inflation and modelled the fixes, the unexpected-behaviour problem this role exists to prevent. I also built an early-payer flag from Day 1-3 cohort data (AUC 0.80), the basis for a concrete onboarding lever. Methods and results in the portfolio.
- **US Stock-Market Valuation & Risk** (Python, statsmodels, SQL). The financial-analyst foundation under the design work: a 150-year study linking market valuation to long-run returns and drawdown risk, built to drive a real allocation call. Full analysis in the portfolio.
- **Games I designed & balanced** (custom JavaScript engines). Proof I balance economies inside real, playable games: Battle, a turn-based RPG with online PvP where every stat and reward has to stay fair, and RocketIO, a real-time strategy game built on a resource-and-missile economy. Both run on engines I wrote myself; playable in the portfolio (merogith.github.io/Portfolio).
- **Next on my list - idle games.** A Classic-WoW-style RPG reimaged as an idle game, the genre I spend the most time in (Idle Maple Story, Slayer Legend, Legends of Idleon, Idle Slayer, Clicker Heroes).

Experience

Independent Financial Coach - Self-employed (2024 - Present)

- Run a one-to-one practice turning budgeting, saving and investing into plain, actionable decisions; design each client's plan and run weekly check-ins in English and Turkish.

Omnichannel Data Analyst - Viatrix Inc. (Dec 2022 - Sep 2023)

- Consolidated records into one master record per person across 70+ markets (Salesforce); fuzzy matching cut manual validation by 40%; cleaned 1M+ records with SQL.

Business Intelligence Analyst - Saksi Kampüs (early-stage edtech) (Dec 2021 - Oct 2022)

- Tracked retention, engagement and CAC in Google Analytics and Looker Studio and steered Meta Ads spend; wrote the business plan and growth projections behind a TRY 1.37M seed crowdfunding round (2022).

Sales & Financial Analysis Intern - Garanti BBVA Investment (Jul 2021 - Sep 2021)

- Built DCF and comparable-company valuation models and set target prices for sell-side equity research.

Education

- M.Sc. Corporate Management - University of Europe for Applied Sciences, Berlin (2022 - 2024).
- B.Sc. Environmental Engineering - METU, Ankara (2013 - 2021).

Honors: published paper "Generative AI in Pharma" (ADCAIJ); Google AI Essentials; METU summer-practice award.

Languages

English (full professional); Turkish (native); Portuguese (dual citizen).